TRI-STATE STEM+ CONFERENCE • 2026

Building Solutions with AI

Custom Tools for Real Problems

Vibe coding for teachers — no programming experience required

START SMALL. BUILD USEFUL.

THE PROBLEM

“I wish there were an app that would just…”

What’s one tiny task you wish a tool could handle?

THE CONCEPT

What is vibe coding?

Describe → Build → Test → Improve

You bring...

The problem, classroom knowledge, decisions.

AI brings...

Draft code and technical suggestions.

You remain responsible for checking what it does.

WHAT I BUILT

One process. Bigger possibilities.

01

Stopwatch

One simple classroom need

02

Layout planner

A more specialized tool

03

ClassSeats

An evolving application

They all started with a problem — not a line of code.

YOUR ROADMAP

Six steps. One repeatable process.

01 IDENTIFY

What problem?

02 GUARDRAILS

What needs protection?

03 DESCRIBE

What should it do?

04 BUILD

Start small.

05 TEST & REFINE

What needs to change?

06 SHARE

How will it be used?

STEP 2 MATTERS

Guardrails before code.

Use pretend data

Prototype with fictional students, classes and scenarios.

Know the data flow

What is collected? Where is it stored, sent or displayed?

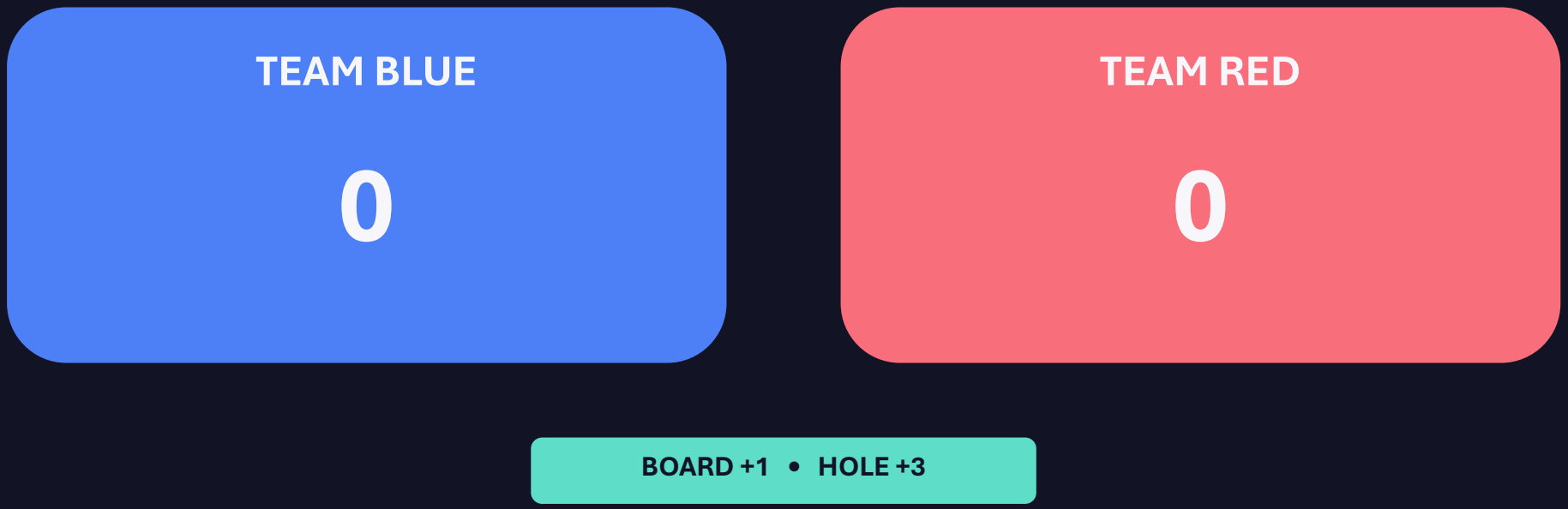
Check approval

Follow district policy before using real student information.

LIVE CHALLENGE

Field Day Cornhole Scorekeeper

A genuinely useful tool. A deliberately tiny first version.



LIVE BUILD

Build → Test → Refine

1 FIRST BUILD

Two teams. +1 and +3 buttons.

2 SMALL IMPROVEMENT

Add Undo and New Game.

3 ONLY IF TIME

Official rules: round-based scoring.

MAKE IT USEFUL

From AI to Google Sites

BUILD

Produce and test the webpage

HOST

Give it a publicly reachable URL

EMBED

Insert the URL in Google Sites

TAKE IT HOME

Your AI development partner

“I am a teacher with no programming experience…”

One starter prompt interviews you, checks privacy risks, agrees on a plan, and helps you build.

RESOURCE QR

ADD QR
WHEN READY

YOUR TURN

What's one problem worth solving?

Small. Specific. Frustrating.

You don't need the solution yet.
Start by describing the problem.

START SMALL

You don't have to become a programmer.

You just need to recognize problems worth solving.

Questions • Resources • Starter prompt